

Michael Chow

Palo Alto, CA · 650-282-0174 · michael.chow@colorado.edu · michael.s.chow@gmail.com

[michaelchow38.github.io](https://github.com/michaelchow38) · [linkedin.com/in/michael-s-chow](https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-s-chow)

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder — B.S. Information Science, Minor in Business · Boulder, CO · Expected May 2028

GPA: 3.78 / 4.00 · Dean's List: Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026

Foothill College — Dual enrollment · Los Altos, CA · June 2022 – March 2023

Henry M. Gunn High School — High School Diploma · Palo Alto, CA · May 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher & Research Assistant — Al-Adala Lab, University of Colorado Boulder · Fall 2026 – Present

PI: [Dr. Bryan Semaan](#) · Supervisor: [Divyanshu Kumar Singh](#), PhD Candidate

- Leading an independent interview study on how esports stakeholders (players, team managers, creators, league staff) explain why competitive structures like franchised leagues and open circuits form and change
- Designed the study's interview questions, a recruitment plan across 8 stakeholder groups, and a plan for analyzing and comparing responses by role
- Support my supervisor's research on caste and data workers in India: helping design interview questions and protocols, coding and labeling qualitative data, and identifying insights

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

CITI Program — Human Research: Social-Behavioral Research Investigators and Key Personnel (Basic Course)

University of Colorado Boulder · Completed September 2026, valid through September 2029

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

- **HCI, design & society:** Design for Accessibility, Designing Interactions, Race and Technology, Information Ecosystems, Design Thinking Seminar, Community-Based Design*, Information Ethics and Policy*
- **Programming, data & statistics:** Programming for Information Science 1 & 2, Statistics for Information Science, Quantitative Reasoning, Calculus 1 (AP credit), Web Data Science*, Fundamental Concepts in Data Science*, Information Exploration*, Information Exposition*

*In progress, Fall 2026

PROJECTS

[Call of Duty World League Player Performance Analysis](#) — Individual project · SQL (SQLite), Python, pandas, Matplotlib

- Used SQL to analyze 22,000+ player-map records from the 2019 Call of Duty World League season (Black Ops 4) to test whether kill/death ratio (K/D) actually predicts winning
- Found K/D was not the stat most tied to winning in any game mode: zone captures led in Control, damage in Hardpoint, and survival rate in Search & Destroy
- Ran data-quality checks that uncovered non-unique map IDs, a broken accuracy field, and an event missing detailed stats, then built a composite key and cleaning rules
- Explained the limits of the findings: winning teams naturally get more kills, so K/D is partly a result of winning, not a cause

[Premier League 2020–21 Title Analysis](#) — Individual project, CU Boulder · Python, pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, BeautifulSoup

- Rebuilt the full league table from raw match data with pandas and NumPy to explain Manchester City's title
- Ran a data-quality check reconciling player-level goals (82) against team totals (83) and traced the gap to an own goal
- Combined CSV and scraped Wikipedia HTML data, sharing findings through Matplotlib charts and plain-language write-ups

[Accessibility Evaluation Through Heat Maps: ECCR and Leeds](#) — Team project, Design for Accessibility (INFO 4871) · Spring 2026

- Evaluated the accessibility of the Engineering Center and Leeds School of Business to identify barriers faced by students with disabilities
- Combined student surveys with on-site inspections, turned the findings into visual heat maps, and delivered evidence-based recommendations for campus improvements

Socially Distributed Cognition: Chipotle Field Study — Individual project, Quantitative Reasoning (INFO 2301) · Spring 2026

- Conducted an in-person field study analyzing how customers, employees, layout, and technology coordinate as one information system
- Documented each station through photos, hand-drawn maps, and observational notes, then proposed design recommendations to improve line efficiency and pricing clarity

LEADERSHIP & PROGRAM MANAGEMENT EXPERIENCE

Esports Team Operations (PUBG Mobile)

Team Manager — Vatic · January 2025 – June 2026

- Directed team operations, scheduling, and communication across competitive events
- Streamlined preparation workflows, improving team efficiency and coordination
- Managed logistics, sponsorship discussions, and day-to-day operations
- Coordinated with other departments to support social media engagement

Team Manager — Wolves Esports · July 2025 – January 2026

- Managed scheduling, competitive operations, and communication between staff and players

Org Manager & Team Manager — Dauntless Esports (continued as Shoot 2 Survive, 2025) · January 2022 – 2025

- Advanced the roster from Open Division to the PUBG Mobile Super League (PMSL), the top professional league in the Americas, through structured player development
- Helped negotiate over \$50,000 in sponsorship deals and expanded brand presence across North America
- Coordinated international travel and logistics for the team's appearance at PMSL Americas in Brazil
- Scheduled scrims and tournaments and managed player preparation

Earlier roles — Team Manager, NRG Galaxy (2023); Org Manager, Lotus Esports (2021 – 2022); Team Manager, Angry Amateurs (2020 – 2021). Handled roster scouting and coordination, sponsorship talks, logistics, and tournament operations.

Youth Sports

Assistant Program Director (promoted from Junior Coach and Assistant Coach) — Palo Alto Soccer Club · July 2020 – July 2024

- Managed scheduling, staffing, and budgeting for multi-team youth programs; built budget and payment spreadsheets
- Oversaw daily operations, improving coordination across departments
- Designed training programs and analyzed performance to improve team results
- Supervised about 3 junior coaches and oversaw a program of 60+ children ages 4–7

SKILLS

- **Programming & data:** Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, BeautifulSoup), SQL (SQLite), Jupyter, Excel, Tableau, Power BI, data cleaning and quality checks
- **Research:** Interview study design, surveys, field observation, qualitative coding, mixed-methods analysis, human subjects research (CITI), design thinking, accessibility evaluation
- **Program management:** Logistics and scheduling, budgeting, sponsorship negotiation, international travel coordination, cross-cultural team communication
- **Tools:** Figma, Miro, Adobe Photoshop (basic), Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, Discord

REFERENCES

Divyanshu Kumar Singh — PhD Candidate, Information Science, University of Colorado Boulder (research supervisor) · divyanshu.singh@colorado.edu

Maximus "Xerias" Thomas — CEO, Dauntless Esports · Contact available upon request